VER. 26.1

Authenticity

Falchions

Table of contents

1. Implementation 3
2. Definition and Description 3
    2.1. Definition 3
    2.2. Description 3
3. General Requirements 5
4. Falchions Type 1 6
    4.1. Historical Sources and Datation 6
    4.2. Examples of Approved Reproductions 7
5. Falchions Type 2 8
    5.1. Historical Sources and Datation 8
    5.2. Examples of Approved Reproductions 10
6. Falchions Type 3 11
    6.1. Historical Sources and Datation 11
    6.2. Examples of Approved Reproductions 14
7. Falchions Type 4 15
    7.1. Historical Sources and Datation 15
    7.2. Examples of Approved Reproductions 15
8. Falchions Type 5 16
    8.1. Historical Sources and Datation 16
9. 2-Handed Falchions 18
    9.1. Historical Sources and Datation 18
    9.2. Examples of Approved Reproductions 20
10. Pommels and Guards 21
    10.1. Pommels 21
    10.2. Guards 23
11. Common Mistakes 23
    11.1. 1-Handed Falchions with D-guards 24
    1.1. Examples of Denied Reproductions 24
    11.2. Beidanas 25
    11.3. Falchions from the Morgan Bible (or Maciejowski Bible) 25
12. Changelog 26

1. Implementation

The document has been created and approved by the General Assembly of 29.11.2025.
The document and its rules will be implemented from the 2029 season (01/01/2029).
Competitors will have 3 seasons to align their equipment with this document and its rules.

2. Definition and Description

2.1. Definition

"**Falchion**" is the term used to describe a single-edged bladed weapon from the Middle Ages in Europe.
The falchion originated in the 12th century and evolved until the 15th century.
Falchions can be one-handed or two-handed.
"**Messer**" is the term used to describe a specific subtype of falchion.

2.2. Description

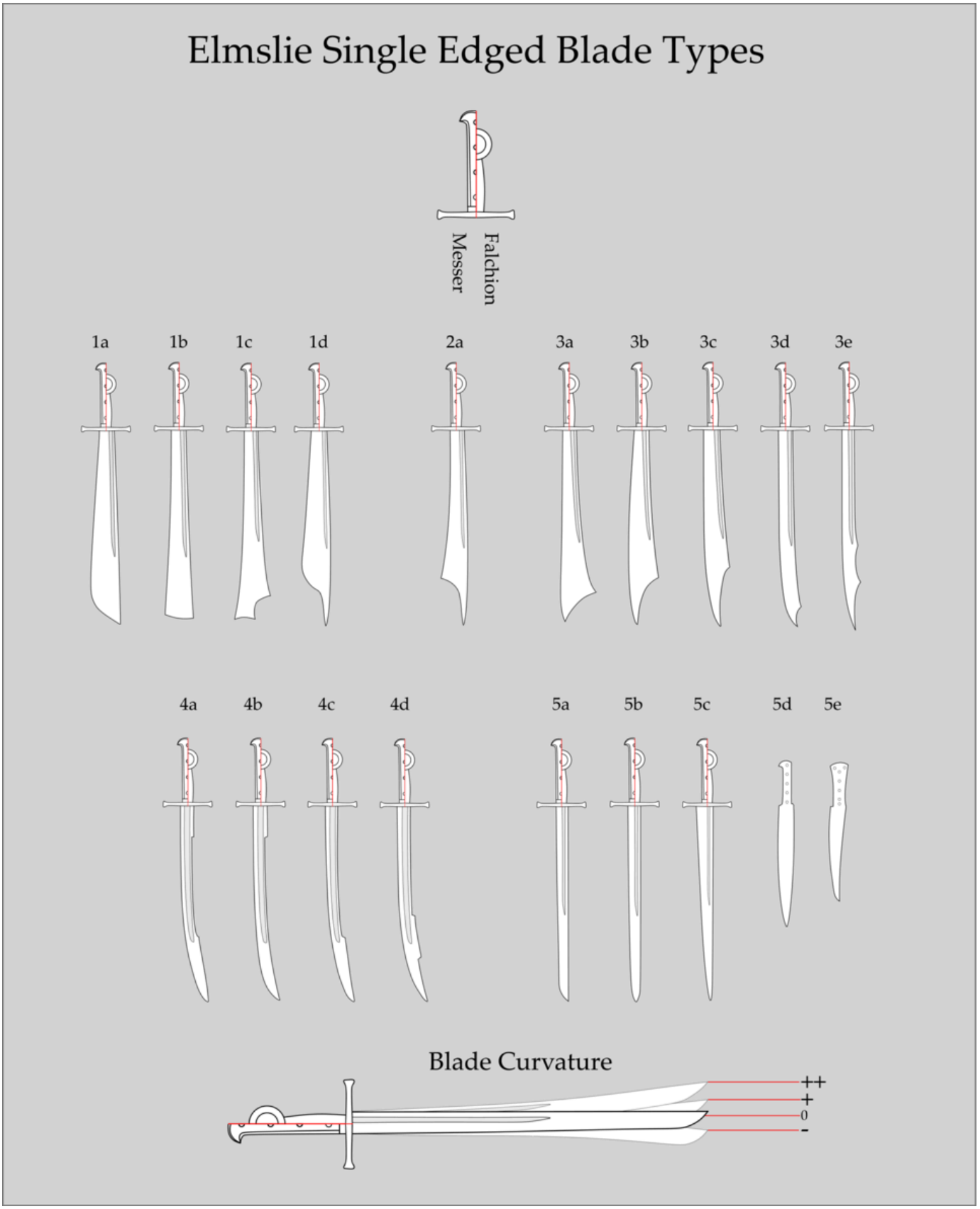
Falchions existed in many forms throughout the Middle Ages.
They have been classified by James Elmslie in 2015, and we will stick to his typology for buhurt.

Type of Falchions:

- **Type 1**
  A straight blade with a wider part on the striking edge.
- **Type 2**
  "Reverse-edged" forward curve, the point must be rounded or removed.
- **Type 3**
  Variations in having scalloped or cutaway tips on the blades.
- **Type 4**
  Curved saber-like blades often associated with, but not exclusive to, Eastern Europe.
- **Type 5**
  Symmetrical single-edged profiles with little to no curvature.
- **2-handed**
  Not classified by James Elmslie , but depicted in manuscripts.

Falchions that are not based on the James Elmslie typology can be accepted if documented by historical sources.

Elmslie Single Edged Blade Types



3. General Requirements

Falchions of any types must:

- be based on historical sources,
- reproduce the proportions and curves based on historical sources,
- match the style of the armor kit of the competitor,
- be conform to the 9.0 section about pommels and guards,
- be conform to the Technical Requirements document for weapons.

All decorations on the falchion must be stylized in accordance with the style of the armor kit of the competitor.

It is prohibited to decorate a falchion with images that are clearly modern and/or offensive. Any metal part of the falchion must conform to the "*Armors and Weapons Aesthetics and Decorations*" document.

Any textile or leather part of the falchion must conform to the "*Textiles and Leather*" document.

4. Falchions Type 1

4.1. Historical Sources and Datation

Type 1 falchions are based on Elmslie typology. They are characterized by a flaring profile, and broad, abrupt tip.

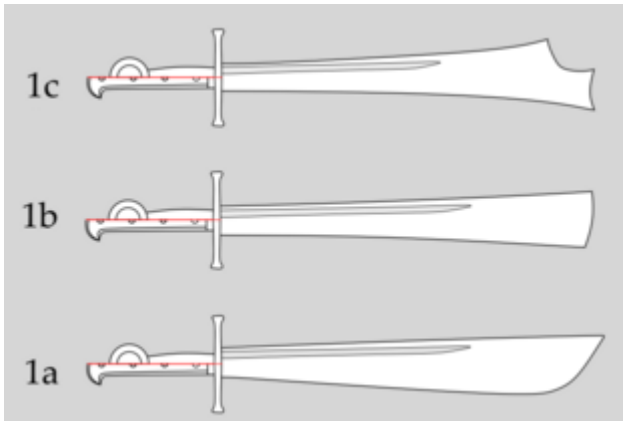
There are 4 subtypes, from 1a to 1d.

All subtypes type 1 falchion have been used since the 13th century.

They are **Approved** for **14th century**, **Transitional** and **15th century armors**.

Type 1d falchion is **Denied** because its pointy edge is not safe.

APPROVED

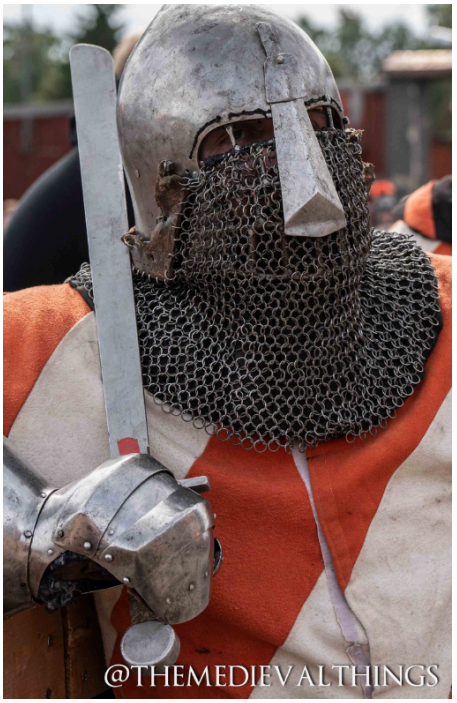


DENIED

Falchion of Cluny - 1270/1280 - France

Falchion of Conyers - 1260/1270 - England

4.2. Examples of Approved Reproductions



Pictures from The Medieval Things ©

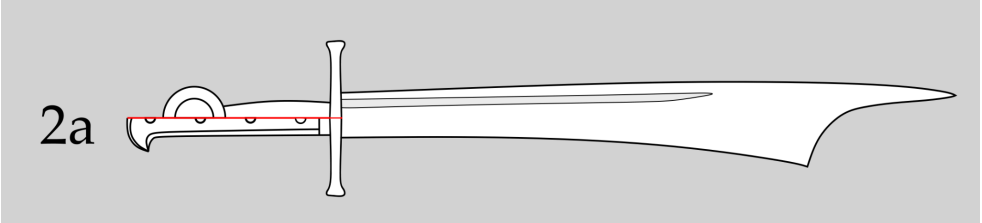
5. Falchions Type 2

5.1. Historical Sources and Datation

Type 2 falchions are based on Elmslie typology. They are also called “reverse-edge falchions”. They are sharpened along the ‘short’ edge, which features a clipped portion, leading to the reinforced thrusting tip.

They are **Approved** for **14th century**, **Transitional** and **15th century armors**.

A particular attention must be paid to the safety of the pointy edge, it must be made to be safe.



BNF Français 246 Histoire Ancienne - C. 1360-1400 - France

Flemish Falchion - C. 1400 - Musée de L’Armée - France

Castello di Avio - 1350 - Italy

5.2. Examples of Approved Reproductions

Picture from Gohurt ©

Picture from The Medieval Things ©

6. Falchions Type 3

6.1. Historical Sources and Datation

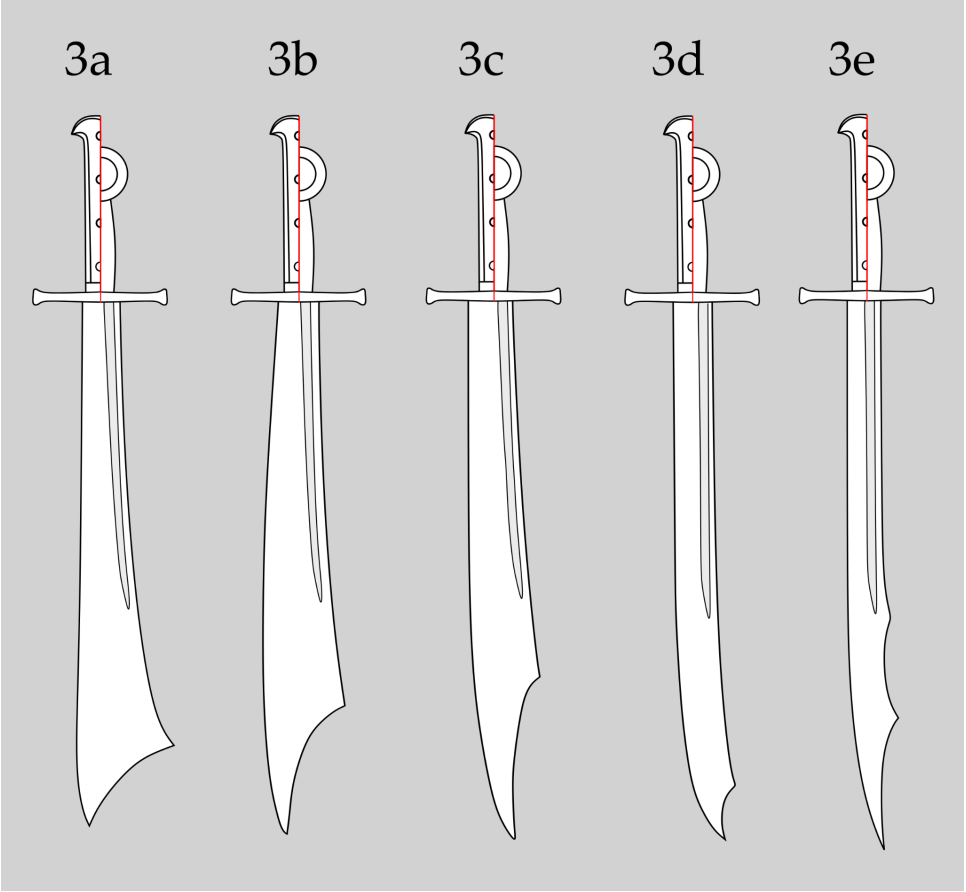
Type 3 falchions are based on Elmslie typology. They are characterized by having scalloped or cutaway tips on the blades of various shapes. The curvature of the blade can vary.

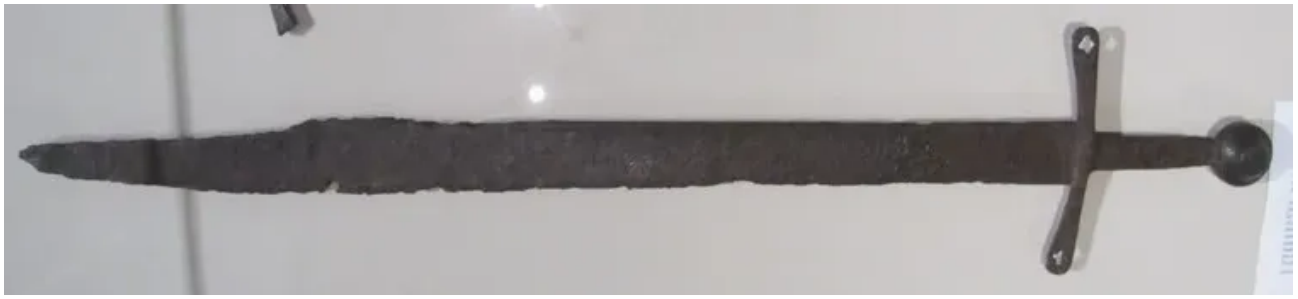
There are 5 subtypes, from 3a to 3e.

All type 3 falchions have been used since the 14th century.

They are **Approved** for **14th century**, **Transitional** and **15th century armors**.

A particular attention must be paid to the safety of the pointy edge, it must be made to be safe.





Falchion from Thorpe - 1350 - England

BNF Français 167 Bible Moralisée - 1345/1355 - France

Morgan M.394 Bible Historiale - 1415 - France

6.2. Examples of Approved Reproductions

Pictures from The Medieval Things ©

7. Falchions Type 4

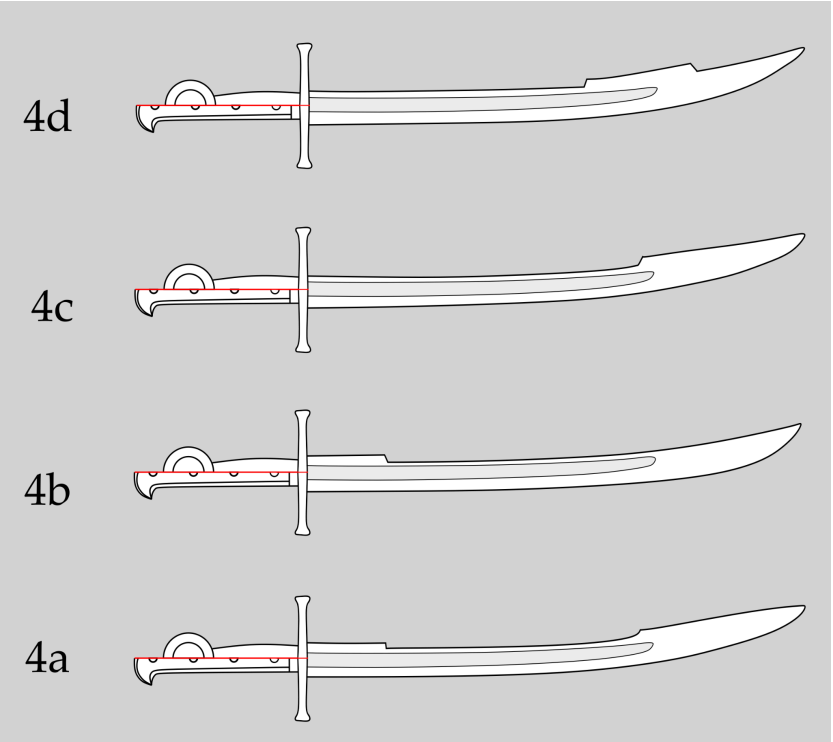
7.1. Historical Sources and Datation

Type 4 falchions are based on Elmslie typology. They are characterized by a curved blade that gives them a sabre look.

There are 4 subtypes, from 4a to 4d.

All type 4 falchions have been used since the 14th century.

They are **Approved** for **14th century**, **Transitional** and **15th century armors**.



7.2. Examples of Approved Reproductions

Picture from Gohurt ©

8. Falchions Type 5

8.1. Historical Sources and Datation

Type 5 falchions are based on Elmslie typology. They are characterized by relatively symmetrical profiles, typically featuring little to no curvature over their length.

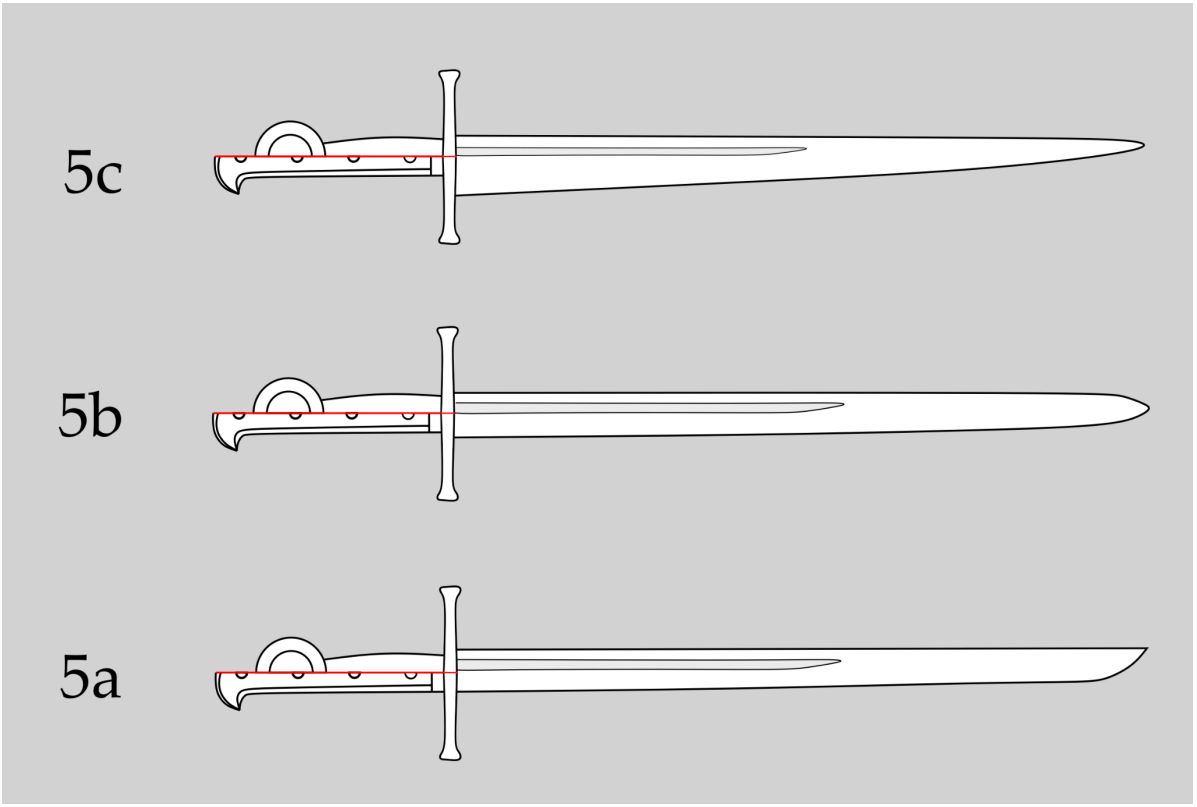
There are 5 subtypes, from 4a to 4e.

All type 5 falchions have been used since the 14th century.

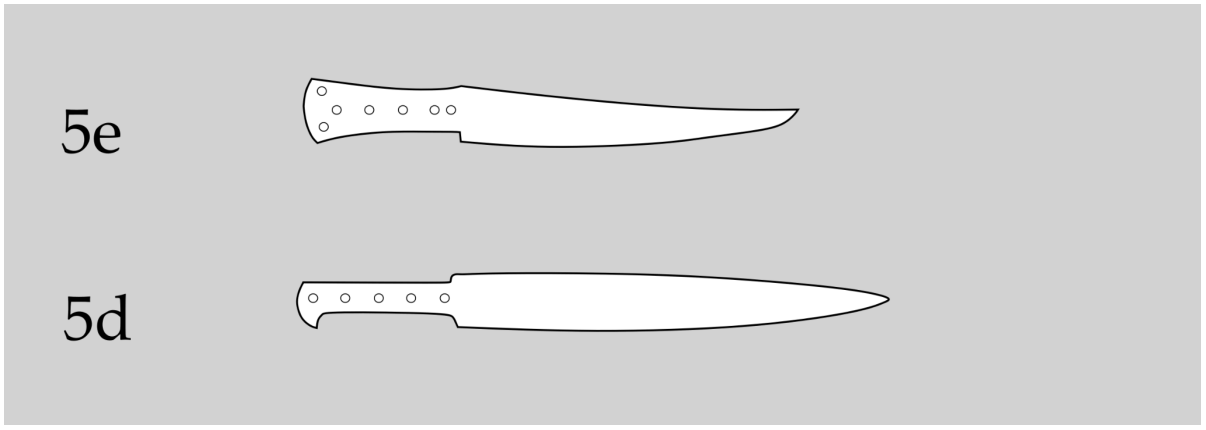
Subtypes 5a, 5b, 5c falchions are **Approved** for **14th century**, **Transitional** and **15th century armors**.

Subtypes 5d and 5e are **Denied** for safety reasons.

APPROVED



DENIED



Morgan M.394 Bible Historiale - 1415 - France

9. 2-Handed Falchions

9.1. Historical Sources and Datation

2-handed falchions are not based on Elmslie typology. They are depicted in manuscripts from the middle ages in Europe.

There are 3 subtypes of 2-handed that are suitable for buhurt:

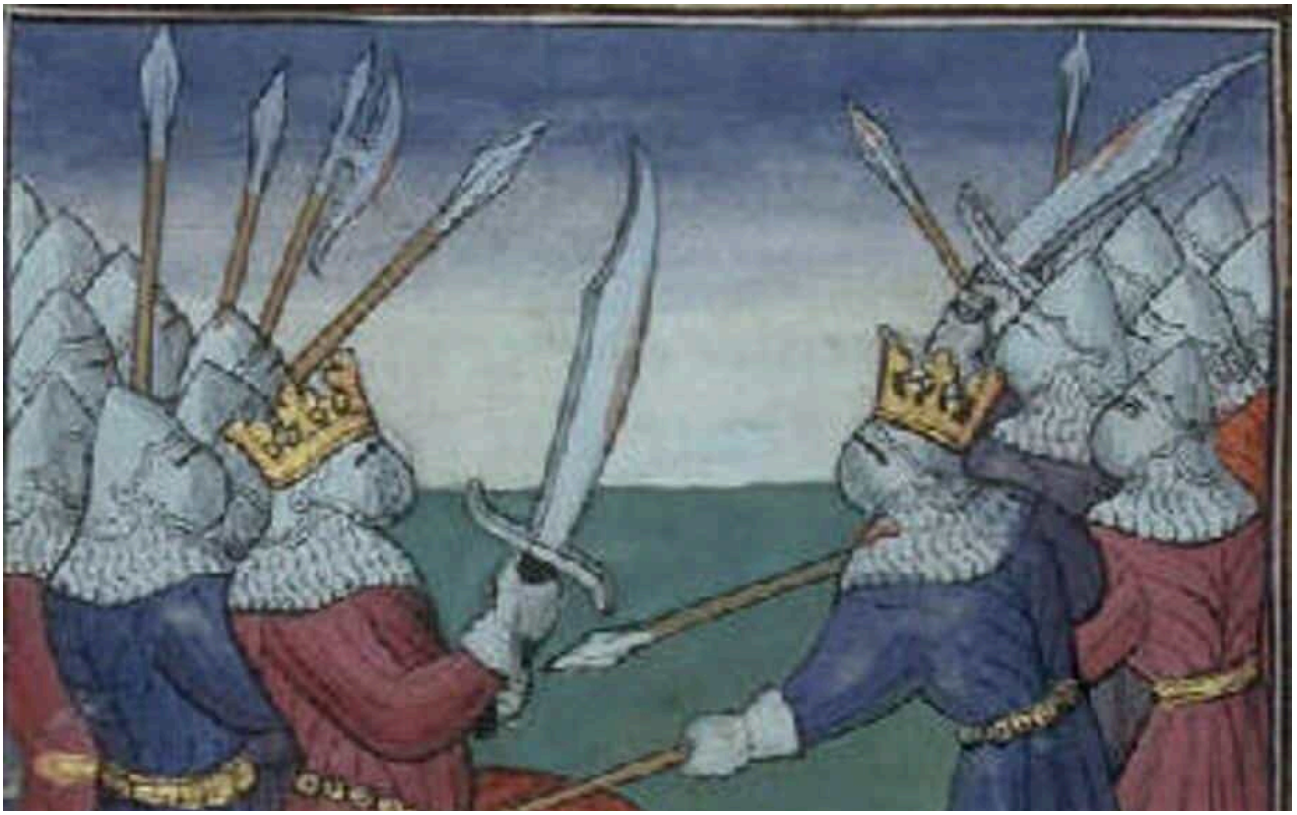
- **Type 2**
  It has a similar shape to 1-handed falchion type 2, with a square guard.
- **Type 3c**
  It has a similar shape to 1-handed falchion type 3c.
- **Type 3e**
  It has a similar shape to 1-handed falchion type 3e.

They are **Approved** for **14th century**, **Transitional** and **15th century armors**.

2-handed Type 2

Romance of Alexander - 1338/1344 - England

2-handed Type 3c



Lyon BM PA 30 Cy commencent les grans croniques de la genealogie des roys de France - 1380 - France

2-handed Type 3e

Martyr of Saint Savinien - Bibliotheque Nationale de France - Department of Manuscripts 50 f. 324v. - second half of the 14th century - France

9.2. Examples of Approved Reproductions

2-Handed Type 2

2-Handed Type 3c

2-Handed Type 3e

Pictures from Medieval Extreme ©

10. Pommels and Guards

10.1. Pommels

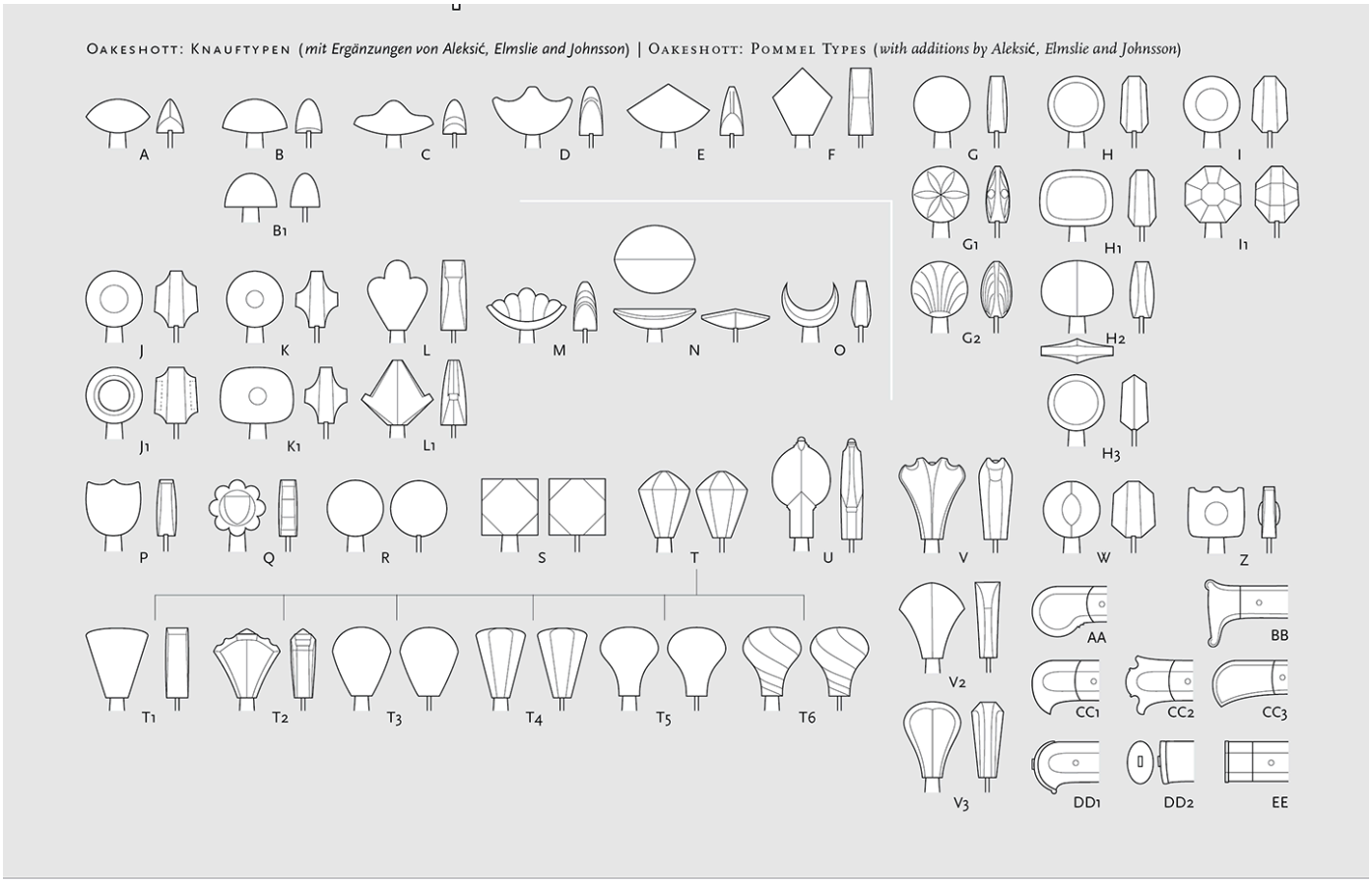
Pommels can be of many forms and designs, mainly of rounded or square shape.

Pommels shapes are sorted under the Oakeshott Typology.

Pommels can be decorated.

Any metal part of the pommel must conform to the "*Armors and Weapons Aesthetics and Decorations*" document.

Example of historical shapes from OakeshottTypology:



Types A to E are all **Denied** as they are from centuries that predate the 14th century.

Types G1 and G2 originated from the 16th century.

They are:

- **Approved** for **16th century armors and weapons**.
- **Denied** for **14th century**, **Transitional** and **15th century armors and weapons.**

For safety reason, it is **Denied** to reproduce a hook shape for the pommel, despite it is documented by historical sources, such as:

10.2. Guards

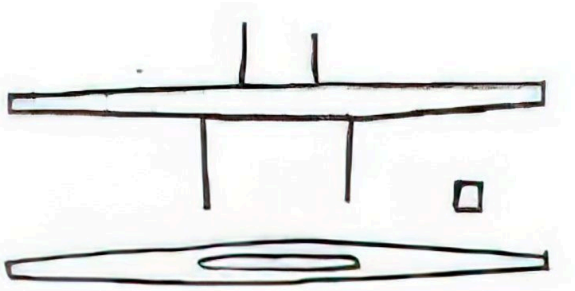
Guards can be of many forms and designs, mainly of straight design for 14th and 15th century designs.

It is recommended to avoid exotic shapes of guards and stick to the classic shapes, widely supported by historical sources.

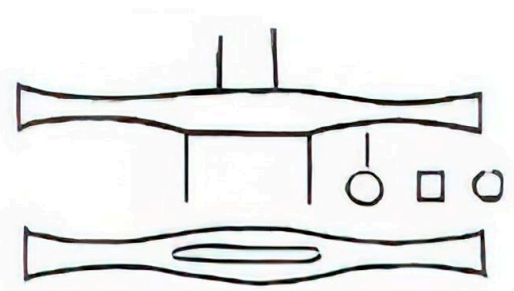
Guards can be decorated.

Any metal part of the pommel must conform to the "*Armors and Weapons Aesthetics and Decorations*" document.

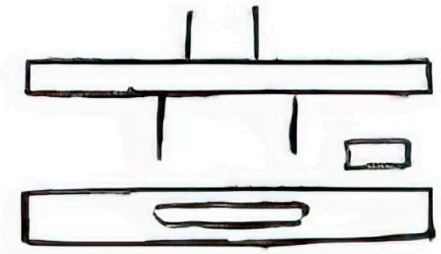
Example of historical shapes from Oakeshott Typology:



Style 1



Style 2



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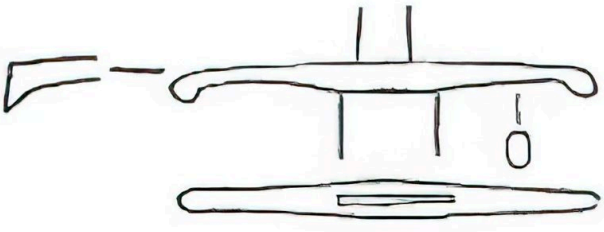
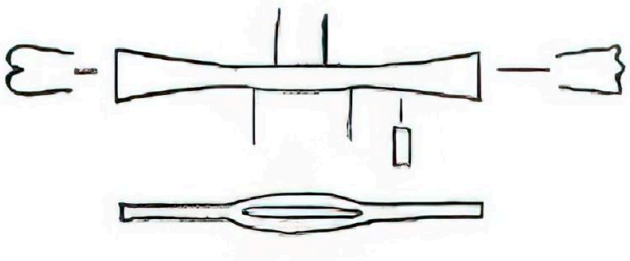
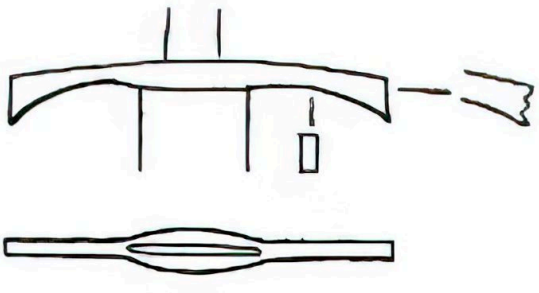


Style 4



Style 5



Style 6

© Ewatt Oakeshott - The Sword in the Age of Chivalry

Note: Oakeshott defined up to 12 different styles of guards, with variations.

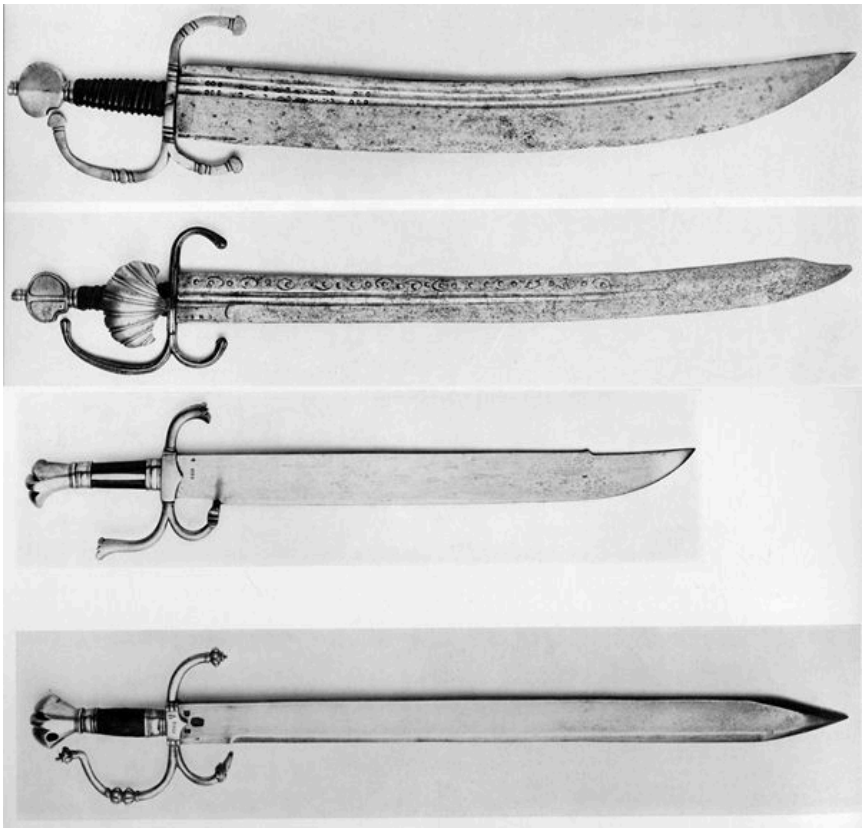
We selected only the first 6 styles to keep the document simple, but other styles of guards from the Oakeshott typology are acceptable to use.

11. Common Mistakes

11.1. 1-Handed Falchions with D-guards

From the 16th century, mainly in Italy, falchions with “D Guard” started to be used for civil combats. They represent a serious risk of injury and can not be used.

All 1-handed falchions reproducing the designs of a 1-handed falchion with a D-guard are **Denied**.



1.1. Examples of Denied Reproductions

Picture from Medieval Extreme ©

11.2. Beidanas

Beidanas are a farming tool from the 17th century in Italy. Despite its falchion inspired design, it is not a weapon for combat and therefore not suitable for buhurt.

All falchions reproducing the designs of a Beidana are **Denied**.

11.3. Falchions from the Morgan Bible (or Maciejowski Bible)

This manuscript is often used for falchions sources. But it originated from the middle of the 13th century, and its design is unsafe for our sport.

All falchions reproducing the designs from this manuscript are **Denied**.

12. Changelog

Below, we will keep track of all the changes made over the lifetime of this document. This way, all our members can see how the documents are changing over time.

January - 2026 (V. 26.1)
Add: Document has been created